India's next big AI leap

Nutanix says it's all about control, cost and real-world impact

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India's AI adoption journey is anything but uniform. "Some customers are experimenting in the public cloud. I think it's an easy way to start experimenting and really try out what you can do with AI. Some customers have actually moved on to realize concerns around token cost and governance and starting to focus on doing things within their private domain," says Anindo Sengupta, VP of AI, Cloud-native and NeoCloudSPs, Nutanix.

According to Sengupta, India's startup ecosystem, the ones based in Bengaluru, could be a significant driver of AI adoption. "India is a huge startup hub. I work closely with the startup ecosystem in Bengaluru and they are really leading a lot of the adoption for all the right reasons."



Anindo Sengupta
VP of AI, Cloud-native and NeoCloudSPs, Nutanix

This sentiment is echoed by Faiz Shakir, Vice President, Sales, Asia Pacific and Japan (APJ), Nutanix, although he believes Indian CEOs are now treating AI as a strategic necessity, not just a fringe experiment. "Different enterprises are at different stages of adopting and monetizing AI. But I think what's very clear is that everyone has realized that they need to have an AI strategy in place and their boards, their CEOs are clearly earmarking budgets and building plans for AI."

I met Anindo Sengupta and Faiz Shakir at Nutanix's .NEXT on Tour Mumbai 2026.



Faiz Shakir
Vice President, Sales, Asia Pacific and Japan (APJ), Nutanix

Tokenomics

One of the more substantial parts of my conversation with Sengupta concerned the total cost of ownership of AI. Businesses consuming frontier models through APIs have relatively straightforward expenses: their token bills are the effective cost of consuming that service. Private AI introduces additional responsibilities, believes Sengupta.

"Our opinion is customers will realize that they need to control token spend. They need to have governed, sovereign AI deployments but then the hard part is the responsibilities for the customers to manage the AI infrastructure and their total cost of ownership is an important aspect there," highlights Sengupta.

Shakir points out another nuance to the tokenomics paradigm, that cheaper tokens don't always mean cheaper AI. "Cost of token is coming down, but utilization has gone up so much, it's still a huge factor," he says.

As AI becomes more accessible, organisations may consume more of it, thereby incurring high costs of AI deployments. For Nutanix, the opportunity lies in simplifying the infrastructure required to operate AI economically. "What Nutanix does is, and what our passion is, we offer our customers the ability to manage the new accelerated computing infrastructure just the way they were managing their traditional enterprise application infrastructure. And it's the same experience for them," explains Sengupta.

Agentic AI's governance

Perhaps the most interesting part of our discussion concerned agentic AI, particularly on the risks associated with autonomous systems executing complex tasks. Who takes accountability when something goes wrong?

"I think the concerns around agentic AI are valid," emphasises Sengupta. Unlike conventional chatbots, these systems can remain active, make decisions and initiate actions. Sengupta identifies three interconnected requirements – securing the agents, controlling their access to intelligence and models, and protecting the enterprise data they have access to.

"The agent itself needs some infra. They need computeqne data. When it comes to data, they need secure access, because agents are only going to be smart based on data, right?"

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